

(as in `$first_name`) when two or more words are used to name them, or by converting the first letter of each word to uppercase (as in `$lastName`). This is done simply to make the name more readable.

Now let us look at the various types of variables:

- **Integer:** These are whole number(s) (-9, 9, 99, 999, etc).
- **Double/Float:** These are floating point numbers or real numbers (0.99, 99.0, etc).
- **String:** These are strings of characters ("Learn", "Java and JavaScript"). This type of variable holds both words and sentences.
- **Boolean:** This holds only two types of data: True and False.
- **Array:** This type of variable holds a list of items.
(`$student = array("class", "section", "roll");`)
- **Object:** This is an instance of a class.

The variable can be accessed from within the 'Variable Scope' where it was defined. A variable cannot be accessed if it was defined in a completely different scope. There are three types of Variable Scope: Superglobal, Global and Function.

Superglobal: The Superglobal variable is a type of pre-defined array in PHP. These variables can be accessed from every section of the code.

Global: Global variables can be viewed throughout the script if these are declared in it.

Function: Local variables are declared in a function scope. These variables are exclusively 'local' to the function in which they are declared. These variables cannot be accessed from outside the Function where it was defined.

In PHP, there are some in-built functions that can check the authenticity of a variable. The function 'isset()' is used to check the existence of a variable. It returns Boolean result (True or False). To remove a variable from the memory, the 'unset()' function is used. The 'empty()' function is used to check whether a variable has been defined and holds a non-empty value.

2.2 Data Types:

'Data Types' can be divided into two groups: 'Core Data Type' and 'Special Data Type'.